

For over 50 years of academic programs in all classes of society – particularly in Hong Kong and Singapore, among others – medicine, engineering and professional disciplines like law and business have been the most attractive programs for parents to encourage their children to enrol in. However, while all of these programs have their merits and benefits, it is my faithful reminder that without the study of human interaction, behaviour and communications, the students would find themselves irrelevant in a fast-changing world and would be restricted in enabling their professional effectiveness in a given situation. It is clearly evidenced when new graduates are undergoing job interviews; many are unable to piece together a complete and comprehensible sentence. In fact, a considerable number of graduates utterly lack social skills and even a basic understanding of human behaviour. The evident uneasiness in interviews and group settings of even those armed with five years of work experience is even more troubling in management education.

What are the caveats to further management education?

Hypercompetitive competition and economic turbulence never before seen at this rate have caused all of us to be focused around growth and change in the midst of increasing shrinking profitability. In this era of rapid innovation, we are charged with managing value whilst being reshaped by globalization and technology, which will reshape our future.

As we continue to devote ourselves to serving the global community through education in both management and business programs through DBA, PhD,

EMBA and MBA and other offerings, we must recognize that our study together is really a commitment and conviction that good leadership and management can indeed make countries, companies and societies more capable and more vibrant.

Whilst a growth in enrolment in management education has been noticed in recent years, one curiously observes that motivation for candidacy varies. Some, for example, would treasure the opportunity to have advanced one's standing in a business career, while others are looking to fill space on an office wall or a conversation piece on the golf course. Despite varying motivation, it's fair to acknowledge that the opportunity is really about advancing one's "intellectual ambition" and advancing our organization's inclusion in the global marketplace.

Our role as business educators is to continue our collaboration with our community and society, inspired by innovation and authentic leadership as we go forth to engage the exciting universe of commerce.

